

Medicaid Spend-Down Strategy Planner

Module 16 — CONSULT ATTORNEY BEFORE IMPLEMENTING

WARNING: Do not implement any spend-down strategy without consulting an elder law attorney. Improper transfers can trigger penalty periods.

CURRENT ASSET SNAPSHOT

Asset	Status	Value
Home equity	(exempt while residing)	\$
Checking/Savings	(countable)	\$
Investments	(countable)	\$
Retirement accounts	(varies by state)	\$
Vehicle	(1 exempt)	\$
Life insurance (cash value)	(countable if >\$1,500)	\$
Other assets		\$
TOTAL COUNTABLE		\$ _____

Medicaid asset limit: ~\$2,000 Amount over limit: \$ _____

ALLOWABLE SPEND-DOWN STRATEGIES (verify with attorney)

- Pay off mortgage or home debt
- Prepay funeral/burial expenses (irrevocable plan)
- Make home modifications for accessibility
- Purchase a newer vehicle (if needed)
- Pay off existing debts
- Hire an elder law attorney for Medicaid planning
- Purchase an irrevocable burial trust
- Pay for dental/vision/hearing care not covered by Medicare

DO NOT: Gift money to family (triggers lookback penalty), hide assets, transfer home without attorney guidance.

Elder law attorney: _____ Appointment: _____